

Lord, I want to be a Christian

Text: African-American spiritual,
Folk Songs of the American Negro, 1907
LORD, I WANT TO BE irregular

Music: African-American spiritual,
Folk Songs of the American Negro, 1907

1 Lord, I want to be a Chris-tian in my heart, in my heart.
2 Lord, I want to be more lov - ing...
3 Lord, I want to be more ho - ly...
4 Lord, I want to be like Je - sus...

Lord, I want to be a Chris-tian in my heart.

In my heart, in my heart,

Lord, I want to be a Chris-tian in my heart.

The musical score is written in 4/4 time with a key signature of three flats (B-flat, E-flat, A-flat). It consists of four staves. The first staff contains four numbered lines of lyrics. The second staff continues the melody with the lyrics 'Lord, I want to be a Chris-tian in my heart.' The third staff features a melodic phrase with the lyrics 'In my heart, in my heart,'. The fourth staff concludes the piece with the lyrics 'Lord, I want to be a Chris-tian in my heart.' The melody is simple and characteristic of African-American spirituals, using a mix of quarter, eighth, and half notes with some ties.